



how to

Twitter.com

With a 1,382% growth rate between Feb 2008 and Feb 2009, Twitter is the fastest growing community destination

Your head in the clouds

Synchronise your contacts and calendars with the cloud

Kumar Jhuremalani

The need to sync your contacts and calendar at all times is a must for all these days. Now with the cloud, this thought has become a reality. Gone are the days where you would face problems of missing a particular contact that is stored only on your work PC. Maintaining an identical set of information on multiple devices such as hand-helds and smart-phones is now easily done using the internet and cloud-based services. With the cloud now lurking above us all, you can keep everything online right from contacts and calendars to even documents and spreadsheets with services provided by various sites such as Google, Yahoo! and even Windows Live. These services allow you to keep everything in sync — right from your home PC, work laptop and even your hand-held device such as a smart phone, so that you don't miss out on anything important. Moreover, with several wireless connectivity options such as WAP, GPRS, Wi-Fi, and even 3G, now available, keeping contacts and calendars in sync is a seamless task. Here we are going to show you how to synchronise your contacts and your calendars using the most reliable services currently available.

Synching contacts and calendars between Gmail and Thunderbird

Calendar

Thunderbird is an email client from Mozilla and a good alternative to Microsoft Outlook. Synching calendars on Thunderbird is not that hard. First you need Lightning — the calendar extension for Thunderbird. Download the XPI file from www.mozilla.com. Once you have done that, go to Tools > Add-ons from the menu bar. Next, click on Install and select the XPI file.

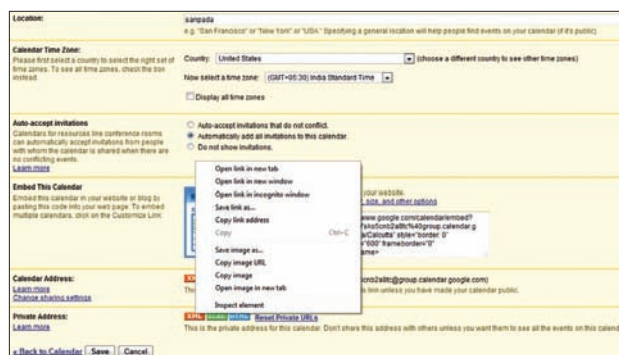
You will also need another extension called Provider. Provider is the extension that will sync your calendar in Thunderbird. You can download and install it the same way as for Lightning.

Now you need to login to Google Calendar and click on settings in the top-right corner and then open the Calendar Settings.

Click on the Calendar you want to sync and scroll all the way down. You will see two options — Calendar Address and Private Address. Next to that you will see three addresses XML, ICAL and HTML.

Right-click XML and select Copy Link Location. If you want to sync multiple calendars then you will have to start from this step and follow the rest of the instructions separately.

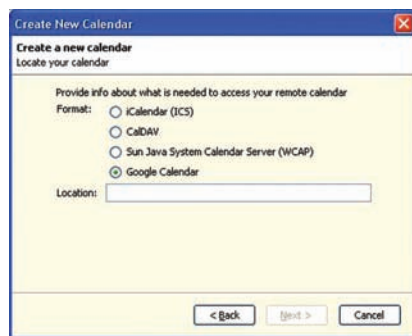
Now fire up Thunderbird and go to



Settings in GCal - Copy the link address of the Private Address XML

File > New > Calendar from the menu bar. The first thing that you will be asked is the location of your calendar — select "On the Network" and click Next.

You now have to specify the Format of the Calendar, select the "Google Calendar" radio button. If you don't see that radio option, make sure you have installed the Provider extension and restarted Thunderbird. In the location box, paste your GCal Private Address XML



Paste the copied Private Address XML in Location that you copied earlier and click Next.

The next window will ask you to give your calendar a name and a colour

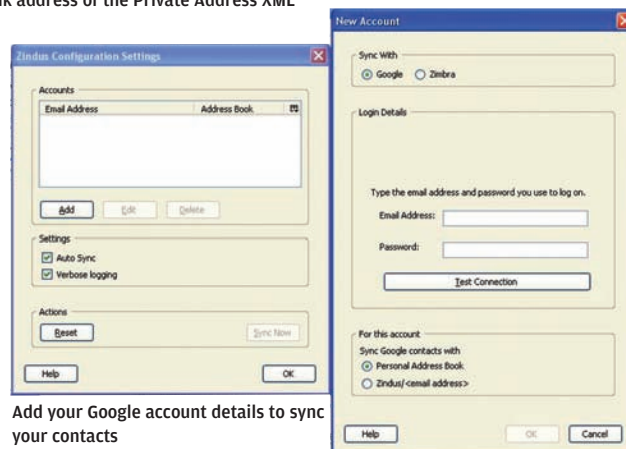
to display your reminders. The "Google Calendar Login" window will appear, where you have to enter your Google username and password. If you only have a single Google Calendar, Provider will have

extracted your username from the XML

feed you just specified. With that done, whatever updates you make to your calendar, either on GCal or on Thunderbird, will be in sync anytime, and anywhere.

Contacts

Synching your Gmail contacts with Thunderbird is the next step, now that your emails and calendars are in sync. The best



Add your Google account details to sync your contacts

thing about Mozilla is that it provides a great number of add-ons and extensions, so even if your software lacks something, there is likely to be an extension or add-on that will make up for it. The add-on we will be using to keep our contacts in sync is called Zindus.

Download the XPI file for Zindus from www.mozilla.com. Next go to Tools > Add-ons in Thunderbird from the menu bar. Click on Install and select the XPI file. Next you will be asked to restart Thunderbird.

After the restart, go to Tools > Zindus. Zindus creates a separate option in the Tools menu. On clicking Add, you will be asked to enter your email ID and password for either Google or Zimbra. Note that Zindus lets you sync your Zimbra contacts too. We selected Google and put in our Gmail username and